INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-14651A
22 October 2001
SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-14651
31 July 1986

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, EMBROIDERED, RANK, GRADE, AND SERVICE STRIPES, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the issue of MIL-DTL-14651 listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification establishes the requirements for embroidered insignia of rank, grade, and service stripes.

1.2 Classification. The insignia covered by this specification will be of the following types, styles, sizes, classes, and subclass as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Army Enlisted Grade
- Style 1 - Army Green
- Size 1 - Large
- Size 2 - Small
- Style 2 - Army Blue
- Size 1 - Large
- Size 2 - Small
- Style 3 - Army White
- Size 1 - Large
- Size 2 - Small
- Style 4 - Woodland Subdued
- Style 5 - Desert Subdued
- Class 1 - Sergeant Major of the Army
- Class 2 - Command Sergeant Major

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in preparing this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, 9325 Gunston Road, Room S112, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455

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Class 3 - Sergeant Major
Class 4 - First Sergeant
Class 5 - Master Sergeant
Class 6 - Sergeant First Class and Platoon Sergeant
Class 7 - Staff Sergeant
Class 8 - Sergeant
Class 9 - Corporal
Class 10 - Private First Class
Class 11 - Private
Class 12 - Specialist Four

Type III - Marine Corps Enlisted Grade
Style 1 - Service
Style 2 - Band Service
Style 3 - Dress
Style 4 - Band Dress
Size 1 - Men
Size 2 - Women
Class 1 - Sergeant Major of the Marine Corps (size 1 only)
Class 2 - Sergeant Major
Class 3 - Master Gunnery Sergeant
Class 4 - First Sergeant
Class 5 - Master Sergeant
Class 6 - Gunnery Sergeant
Class 7 - Staff Sergeant
Class 8 - Sergeant
Class 9 - Corporal
Class 10 - Lance Corporal
Class 11 - Private First Class

Type IV - General Officers, Army and Air Force, Rank
Style 1 - Army Woodland Subdued
Style 2 - Air Force Woodland Subdued
Style 4 - Air Force Desert Subdued
Style 5 - Army Desert Subdued
Class 1 - General
Class 2 - Lieutenant General
Class 3 - Major General
Class 4 - Brigadier General
Size 1 - 1 inch star
Size 2 - 5/8 inch star
Size 3 - 3/8 inch star (Style 2 and 4, Class 1 only)
Size 4 - 3/4 inch star (Style 2 and 4 only)

Type V - Officers, Army and Air Force, Rank
Style 1 - Army Woodland Subdued
Style 2 - Air Force Woodland Subdued
Style 4 - Army and Air Force Desert Subdued
Class 1 - Colonel
Class 2 - Lieutenant Colonel
Class 3 - Major

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Class 4 - Captain
Class 5 - First Lieutenant
Class 6 - Second Lieutenant
Class 7 - Chief Warrant Officer W-4
Class 8 - Chief Warrant Officer W-3
Class 9 - Chief Warrant Officer W-2
Class 10 - Warrant Officer W-1
Class 11 - Chief Warrant Officer W-5 and Master Warrant Officer W-4

Type VI - Insignia, Stripes, Service
Style 1 - Army
Size 1 - Large
Size 2 - Small
Style 2 - Marine Corps
Class 1 - Service
Class 2 - Dress
Size 1 - Men
Size 2 - Women
Subclass 1 - First Enlistment
Subclass 2 - Second Enlistment
Subclass 3 - Third Enlistment
Subclass 4 - Fourth Enlistment
Subclass 5 - Fifth Enlistment
Subclass 6 - Sixth Enlistment
Subclass 7 - Seventh Enlistment

Type VII - Insignia, Bar, Overseas Service
Class 1 - Army
Size 1 - Large
Size 2 - Small

Type VIII - Air Force Enlisted Grade
Style 1 - Full Color
Style 2 - Woodland Subdued
Style 3 - Desert Subdued
Size 1 - Large
Size 2 - Small
Class 1 - Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force
Class 2 - Chief Master Sergeant
Class 3 - Chief Master Sergeant with First Sergeant Device
Class 4 - Senior Master Sergeant
Class 5 - Senior Master Sergeant with First Sergeant Device
Class 6 - Master Sergeant
Class 7 - Master Sergeant with First Sergeant Device
Class 8 - Technical Sergeant
Class 9 - Staff Sergeant
Class 10 - Senior Airman
Class 11 - Airman First Class
Class 12 - Airman
Class 13 - Command Chief Master Sergeant

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Type IX - General Officers, Army and Air Force, Rank Insignia Tab
Style 1 - Army Woodland Subdued
Style 2 - Air Force Woodland Subdued
Style 3 - Army Desert Subdued
Style 4 - Air Force Desert Subdued
Class 1 - General
Class 2 - Lieutenant General
Class 3 - Major General
Class 4 - Brigadier General

Type X - Officers, Army and Air Force, Rank Insignia Tab
Style 1 - Army Woodland Subdued
Style 2 - Air Force Woodland Subdued
Style 3 - Army Desert Subdued
Style 4 - Air Force Desert Subdued
Class 1 - Colonel
Class 2 - Lieutenant Colonel
Class 3 - Major
Class 4 - Captain
Class 5 - First Lieutenant
Class 6 - Second Lieutenant
Class 7 - Chief Warrant Officer W-5 and Master Warrant Officer W-4 (Style 1 only)
Class 8 - Chief Warrant Officer W-4 (Style 1 only)
Class 9 - Chief Warrant Officer W-3 (Style 1 only)
Class 10 - Chief Warrant Officer W-2 (Style 1 only)
Class 11 - Warrant Officer W-1 (Style 1 only)

Type XI - Enlisted, Army, Rank Insignia Tab
Style 1 - Woodland Subdued
Style 2 - Desert Subdued
Class 1 - Sergeant Major of the Army
Class 2 - Command Sergeant Major
Class 3 - Sergeant Major
Class 4 - First Sergeant
Class 5 - Master Sergeant
Class 6 - Sergeant First Class and Platoon Sergeant
Class 7 - Staff Sergeant
Class 8 - Sergeant
Class 9 - Corporal
Class 10 - Private First Class
Class 11 - Private
Class 12 - Specialist Four

Type XII - Enlisted, Air Force, Rank Insignia Tab
Style 1 - Woodland Subdued
Style 2 - Desert Subdued
Class 1 - Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force
Class 2 - Command Chief Master Sergeant
Class 3 - Chief Master Sergeant
Class 4 - Chief Master Sergeant with First Sergeant Device
Class 5 - Senior Master Sergeant

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Class 6 - Senior Master Sergeant with First Sergeant Device
Class 7 - Master Sergeant
Class 8 - Master Sergeant with First Sergeant Device
Class 9 - Technical Sergeant
Class 10 - Staff Sergeant
Class 11 - Senior Airman
Class 12 - Airman First Class
Class 13 - Airman

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS

A-A-50199 - Thread, Polyester Core, Cotton- or Polyester-Covered
A-A-52094 - Thread; Cotton
CCC-C-461 - Cloth, Twill, Uniform Cotton

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-C-29405 - Cloth, Broadcloth: Wool and Wool/Nylon

FEDERAL STANDARDS

FED-STD-191 - Textile, Test Methods

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of the above specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Document Order Desk, DODSSP, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094. Or visit the DODSSP web site at http://astimage.daps.dla.mil for online access to standardization documents.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

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THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY DRAWINGS AND CARTOONS

B-3-(Series) Insignia of Grade/Rank, Various
B-11-(Series) Service Stripes, Various

OTHER GOVERNMENT FURNISHED CARTOONS

Marine Corps Cartoons as required in the contract or order (see 6.2)

(Copies of drawings and/or cartoons required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.3 Non-Government publications and references. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS are issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

(Non-government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other information services.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS

AATCC-16 - Colorfastness to Light
AATCC-96 - Dimensional Changes in Commercial Laundering of Woven and Knitted Fabrics Except Wool
AATCC-99 - Dimensional Changes of Woven or Knitted Wool Textiles: Relaxation, Consolidation and Felting

(These standards can be obtained from the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, P.O. Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY CONTROL

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 1993 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(This standard can be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control, 611 East Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53202.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-D276 - Standard Test Methods for Identification of Fibers in Textiles
ASTM-D1907 - Standard Test Method for Linear Density of Yarn (Yarn Number) by the Skein Method
ASTM-D3775 - Standard Test Method for Fabric Count of Woven Fabric
ASTM-D3776 - Standard Test Method for Mass per Unit Area (Weight) of Fabric
ASTM-D5034 - Standard Test Method for Breaking Force and Elongation of Textile Fabrics (Grab Test)

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ASTM-D6193 - Standard Practice for Stitches and Seams

(These standards can be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

M.J. KAHN

M.J. Kahn Style and Shade Base Cloth

(Information on the referenced base cloth shade can be requested from M.J. Kahn, 510 W. 27th Street, New York, New York 10001.)

CARABELA TRADING COMPANY

C-Series Base Cloth Shades

(Information on the referenced base cloth shades can be requested from Carabela Trading Company, 10 Fairmant Avenue, Chatham, New Jersey 07928.)

CARR TEXTILES

PC-Series Base Cloth Shades

(Information on the referenced base cloth shades can be requested from Carr Textiles, 243 Wolfner Drive, Fenton, Missouri 63026.)

IRA GREEN, INC.

DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1993 Edition

(This publication can be obtained from Ira Green, Inc., 177 Georgia Avenue, Providence, RI 02905.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.1. The sample shall be a finished item. The term "finished item" is defined as one insignia for each individual insignia, one pair for paired insignia, and one strip for insignia furnished in strips.

3.2 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmental preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible provided that the material meets or exceeds operational and maintenance requirements and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

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3.3 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein. Verification shall be in accordance with the standards and methods specified in 4.3.1, Table III.

3.3.1 Embroidery yarn.

3.3.1.1. Material identification. The embroidery yarn shall be a semi-dull continuous filament, regenerated cellulose type rayon, 2-ply Schiffli type or Multihead yarn. The use of 2-ply polyester is authorized in lieu of rayon. Denier of the yarn shall be as specified on the cartoon or drawing. Comparable sizes are as follows:

SCHIFFLI		**MULTIHEAD**	
Rayon	Polyester	Rayon	Polyester
150/2	135/2	150/2 or 35 weight	-----
100/2	90/2	120/2 or 40 weight	120/2 or 40 weight
75/2	70/2	-----	95/2

3.3.1.2 Color. The color of embroidery yarns for the background (when applicable) and device shall be as shown in TABLE I. The border stitching, when required, shall be as indicated on the cartoon. The use of sulfur dyes is prohibited.

3.3.1.3 Color matching. The color shall match the specified color from the *DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1993 Edition* when viewed under filtered tungsten lamps which approximate artificial daylight having a correlated color temperature of 7000 ± 500 K, with illumination of 100 ± 20 foot candles. The color shall also be a good match to the specified color under incandescent lamplight at 2300 ± 100 K.

3.3.1.4 Colorfastness. When tested, the dyed embroidered yarn shall show good fastness to wet-dry cleaning, laundering, and light except the colorfastness for black, blue, and red shades shall be not less than fair for laundering.

3.3.2 Bobbin yarn. The bobbin yarn shall be a continuous multi-filament nylon, 2-ply cotton, or 2-ply spun polyester yarn. The yarn shall be undyed except that the yarn for Type I insignia may be dyed black. When the bobbin yarn is dyed black, it shall show fair colorfastness to wet-dry cleaning and laundering. The use of sulfur dyes is prohibited.

3.3.3 Stitching Thread. The thread for stitching the turned under edges of Type III, Styles 1 and 2 insignia shall be cotton thread conforming to Type I, 3 ply, Ticket No. 50 of A-A-52094. The thread shall be dyed Khaki, conforming to HCS 67193 of *DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1993 Edition* (see 2.3), and shall show good fastness to laundering and light.

3.3.4 Overedge stitching yarn and thread.

3.3.4.1 Material identification. The yarn and thread used for overedge stitching shall be 600 or 1200 denier multi-filament bright rayon or polyester for cover thread (see 3.5.3.1) and Type III, 3-ply, Ticket No. 00, of A-A-52094 or Ticket No. 50, 2-ply of A-A-50199 for needle and looper threads.

3.3.4.2 Color. The color of the yarn and the thread used for overedge stitching shall be as specified for the embroidered border on the applicable drawing or cartoon. (See also Table I.) The use of sulfur dyes is prohibited.

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3.3.4.3 Colorfastness. When tested, the dyed overedge stitching yarn and thread shall show good fastness to wet-dry cleaning, laundering, and light except the colorfastness for black, blue, and red shades shall be not less than fair for laundering.

TABLE I. **Color of embroidery and overedge yarns.**

Type, Style, Class	Embroidered Background	Color of Embroidered Border/Overedge	Device
Type I			
Style 1	N/A	Army Green HAF 67131	Goldenlight HG 67107
Style 2	N/A	Midnight Blue HZ 67125	Goldenlight HG 67107
Style 3	N/A	White HA 67101	Goldenlight HG 67107
Style 4	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Style 5	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Type III			
Style 1	N/A	N/A	Olive HAJ 67134
Style 2	N/A	N/A	Olive HAJ 67134
Style 3	N/A	Marine Corps Scarlet HBD 67154	Olive HAJ 67134 or Gold HF 67106 1/
Style 4	N/A	Marine Corps Scarlet HBD 67154	Gold HF 67106
Type IV			
Style 1	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Style 2	N/A	N/A	Flag Blue HY 67124
Style 4	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Style 5	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Type V (all styles)	N/A	N/A	As specified on cartoon
Type VI			
Style 1	N/A	N/A	Goldenlight HG 67107 & Army Green HAF 67131
Style 2, class 1	N/A	Marine Corps Scarlet HBD 67154	Olive HAJ 67134
Style 2, class 2	N/A	Marine Corps Scarlet HBD 67154	Gold HF 67106
Type VII	N/A	N/A	Goldenlight HG 67107 & Army Green HAF 67131
Type VIII			
Style 1	Graphite Blue HCF 67181	Graphite Blue HCF 67181	White HA 67101
Style 2	N/A	Olive HAJ 67134	Flag Blue HY 67124
Style 3	N/A	Khaki HCS 67193	Spicebrown HCV 67196

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TABLE I. **Color of embroidery and overedge yarns.** - Continued

Type, Style, Class	Embroidered Background	Color of Embroidered Border/Overedge	Device
Type IX			
Style 1	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Style 2	N/A	N/A	Flag Blue HY 67124
Style 3	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Style 4	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Type X (all styles)	N/A	N/A	As specified on cartoon
Type XI			
Style 1	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Style 2	N/A	N/A	Black HAN 67138
Type XII			
Style 1	N/A	N/A	Flag Blue HY 67124 **2**/
Style 2	N/A	N/A	Spicebrown HCV 67196 **3**/

1/ As specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).
2/ Except outline on the Airman, Airman First Class, and Senior Airman shall be Olive Drab HAH 67133.
3/ Except outline on the Airman, Airman First Class, and Senior Airman shall be Black Han 67138.

3.3.5 Base cloth.

3.3.5.1 Except Type III, Styles 3 and 4, and Type VI, Style 2. The base cloth for all insignia, except those listed above, shall be 100% cotton, 50/50 polyester/cotton, or 65/35 polyester/cotton, three up, one down, left hand twill, 7.0 to 8.3 ounces per square yard, single ply warp and filling, with a breaking strength of not less than 150 lbs. in the warp and 80 lbs. in the filling. The residual shrinkage shall be not more than 2 percent in either the warp or filling direction and the cloth shall have not less than fair colorfastness to laundering when tested.

3.3.5.2 Type III, Styles 3 and 4, and Type VI, Style 2. Wool base cloth for Type III, Styles 3 and 4, and Type VI, Style 2 insignia shall conform to Type I or II of MIL-C-29405, except the finished cloth shall show fair fastness to crocking, wet-dry cleaning, and light.

3.3.5.3 Color. The color of the base cloth shall be as shown in TABLE II. ✳DPSC Handbook 4120-1 color references are from the *List of Armed Services Colors for Clothing, Textiles and Equipment, 31 March 1989,* which is obsolete. The DPSC colors are included for historical reference only. Base cloth colors shall be the same as or equal to the M.J. Kahn, Carabela, or Carr colors cited.

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TABLE II. **Color of base cloth.**

Type, Style, Class	Base Cloth Color			
	✳DPSC Handbook	M.J. Kahn	Carabela	Carr
Type I				
Style 1	Army Green 159		C2037	
Style 2	Dark Blue 152		C1120	PC-DNA
Style 3	White			PC-WHT
Style 4	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 5	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type III				
Style 1	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Style 2	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Style 3	(Wool) Scarlet 2501	Style 10455/Shade 9649		
Style 4	(Wool) Scarlet 2501	Style 10455/Shade 9649		
Type IV				
Style 1	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 2	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 4	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Style 5	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type V				
Style 1	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 2	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 4	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type VI				
Style 1	Army Green 159		C2037	
Style 2	(Wool) Scarlet 2501	Style 10455/Shade 9649		
Type VII				
Class 1	Army Green 159		C2037	
Type VIII				
Style 1	Dark Blue 152		C1120	PC-DNA
Style 2	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 3	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type IX				
Style 1	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 2	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 3	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Style 4	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type X				
Style 1	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 2	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV

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TABLE II. **Color of base cloth.** - Continued.

Type, Style, Class	Base Cloth Color			
	✳DSCP Handbook	M.J. Kahn	Carabela	Carr
Style 3	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Style 4	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type XI				
Style 1	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 2	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN
Type XII				
Style 1	Olive Green 107		C2012	PC-OLV
Style 2	Khaki 2120		C4120	PC-TAN

3.3.6 Backing material. The backing material, where specified, shall be a light, open-weave, single-ply fabric weighing 2.5 ounces (minimum) per square yard having a minimum thread count of 40 ends in the warp and 20 ends in the filling. It shall have a minimum breaking strength of 30 pounds in the warp direction and 20 pounds in the filling direction. At the option of the manufacturer, a non-woven pressed fiber material shall be permitted as backing material provided that it satisfies the performance requirements stated herein.

3.3.7 Stiffener

3.3.7.1 Fabric finish. When specified, insignia shall be treated on the reverse side with a fabric finish which will stiffen the insignia to facilitate subsequent processing. The fabric finish shall not affect the colors on the face of the insignia; cause puckering which seriously affects the appearance of insignia; or react adversely to storage, laundering, wet-dry cleaning, or ironing.

3.3.7.2 Rubber base adhesive. Type III, Styles 1 and 2 insignia shall be coated on the back with a natural rubber or synthetic rubber-like base adhesive which shall hold the stitches in place and give the insignia a firm, pliable finish which shall not harden, crack, or transfer onto the uniform cloth as a result of wear, storage, laundering, wet-dry cleaning, or ironing.

3.4 Design. Unless otherwise indicated, the design and color for embroidered insignia shall be as shown on the Government furnished cartoon and drawing (see 6.2). Each pair of grade insignia for Type III, all Styles, Size 1, Class 1 shall consist of a left and right insignia conforming to TIOH drawing B-3-82. Each pair of rank insignia for Type V, all Styles, Class 1 shall consist of a left and right insignia conforming to TIOH drawing B-3-3.

3.5 Construction. The insignia shall be embroidered on an automatic type embroidery machine in accordance with this specification and the Government furnished cartoon. Cartoons are furnished for design; color of yarns; placement of stitches; number of under, cover, miscellaneous, and minimum stitches required. Because all cartoons are based on Schiffli embroidery machine capabilities, the stitch count required by the applicable cartoon shall be doubled for other than Schiffli embroidery machines. The density of cover stitches may be increased in critical areas where defects may occur. All thread ends shall be trimmed.

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3.5.1 Embroidery stitches. The embroidery stitches shall be of the type, length, number, and density specified on the applicable Government cartoon. (The embroidery stitches for Marine Corps insignia shall not be more than 1/8 inch in length.) The total stitches specified on the cartoon are full stitches and constitute two revolutions or movements of the Schiffli machine. Underlay stitches shown on the cartoon by numbers are 1/2 stitches (one movement of the machine) but are converted to full stitches on the tabular listing. Except where otherwise indicated in the cartoon, all letters shall be underlaid and formed with blatt stitches. When a first article has been specifically approved for appearance of the embroidery stitching prior to production, deliveries shall be in this respect equal to or better than the approved article. Care shall be taken in embroidering the crossed rifles device on the base cloth of Type III, Styles 1 and 3 insignia so that:

a. The point at which the rifles cross is at the vertical center of the insignia.

b. The crossed rifles device shall be horizontally balanced and equally divided left and right of the vertical centerline.

c. The ends of each rifle shall be equidistant from the edges of the arcs.

3.5.1.1 Background stitches. Insignia requiring background stitching shall have either horizontal or vertical background stitching (as indicated on the applicable Government cartoon), and the stitch shall be 3/16 inch in length ± 1/32 inch interlocking in evenly spaced rows (satin fill). Horizontal background stitching shall run in a vertical row and vertical background stitching shall run in a horizontal row. The visible width of the embroidered row shall not be more than 5/64 inch. The number of visible rows and the density (number of stitches per inch in a stitch line) shall be as indicated on the applicable Government cartoon.

3.5.1.2 Device stitches. Unless otherwise specified, device stitches shall be in accordance with the applicable Government cartoon with respect to spacing of the rows, number of visible rows, and length and density of stitches. Translation of curvatures and other device features shall be executed with embroidery stitching finished evenly to effect a clean outline.

3.5.1.3 Underlay stitches. When underlay stitches are required, the number of stitches shall be as indicated on the cartoon. Where underlay is required in areas of design showing rows of stitches, the underlay stitches shall be inserted in a criss-cross pattern. In other areas requiring underlay, the underlay stitches shall be inserted in the direction most suitable for proper design execution.

3.5.1.4 Stiele stitches. The length and density of required stiele stitches shall be tightly drawn and well executed to produce a clear, sharp edging and shall conform to the applicable Government cartoon. For Marine Corps insignia, background stitching between rows of stiele stitches in the arcs and bars shall be 1/16 inch and these areas, as well as all center devices (star, bursting bomb, diamond, or crossed rifles), shall be well rounded and raised with sufficient and properly inserted underlay stitches to produce the fullness and depth shown on the approved article. The stiele stitches for Marine Corps insignia shall not be more than 1/32 inch in length.

3.5.1.5 Border stitches. The following insignia shall be bordered by a schrage stitch or a combination of a blatt stitch with a stiele stitch, provided the combination is equal in density to the schrage stitch specified in the cartoon:

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Type I, Styles 1 - 3
Type III, Styles 3 and 4 on wool base cloth
Type VI, Style 2 on wool base cloth
All Type VIII.

3.5.2 Stiffener

3.5.2.1 Type I, Styles 1 - 3; Type VII, and Type VIII. These insignia may be treated on the reverse side with a fabric finish such as that described in 3.3.7.1. The use of backing material specified in 3.3.6 shall be permitted provided that it does not protrude at any point beyond the outline of the finished insignia.

3.5.2.2 Type III, Styles 1 and 2. These insignia shall be coated on the back with a natural rubber base adhesive described in 3.3.7.2.

3.5.2.3 Type III, Styles 3 and 4 and Type VI, Style 2. These insignia on wool base cloth shall be backed with backing material specified in 3.3.6.

3.5.3 Cutting and finishing

3.5.3.1 Overedge stitching. Overedge stitching shall be superimposed over the border of the following insignia using yarn and thread specified in 3.3.4:

Type I, Styles 1 - 3
Type III, Styles 3 and 4 on wool base cloth
Type VI, Style 2 on wool base cloth
All Type VIII.

a. The overedge stitching shall conform to Type 504 (Figure 37) or Type 505 (Figure 38) of ASTM D6193 except two ends of 600 denier or one end of 1200 denier shall be used for the cover threads. These shall be 24 stitches ± 4 stitches per inch, and the stitch length shall be 1/8 inch ± 1/32 inch. Tolerance on width shall be acceptable only if the overedge stitching completely covers the border stitching and does not cover the stripe.

b. The overedge stitching shall start and finish at the upper left point or corner. Where practical, overedge stitching shall be continuous from start to finish. The rounding of corners or angles shall not be permitted. If the stitching runs off a corner and begins in a new direction, the stitching ends shall be trimmed before being locked in by overedge stitching in a new direction. The final free end of the overedge stitching shall be brought to the back of the insignia and secured with adhesive. The free end shall not be less than 1/2 inch in length and no adhesive shall be permitted within 1/8 inch of the finished insignia edge.

3.5.3.1.1 Optional methods of securing final free end. At the option of the contractor, the final free end of the overedge stitching may be secured by blind-stitching 1/4 inch or less of the terminal end to the back of the insignia by hand or machine. Or where size and configuration permit, the final end may be secured by application of a 3/8 inch by 1 inch (approximate) rectangle of masking tape. No part of the tape shall be within 1/8 inch of the finished edge of the insignia.

3.5.3.2. Type I, Styles 1, 2, 3 and Type VIII. These insignia shall be cut in single units, and the base cloth shall be evenly trimmed as close to the outside of the embroidered border edge

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as is possible without cutting the stitching. The base cloth shall be trimmed close enough to ensure the overedge stitching covers the embroidered border.

3.5.3.3 Type III, Styles 1 and 2, Sizes 1 and 2. These insignia shall be finished by uniformly turning under the edges of the background material 3/16 to 1/4 inch and uniformly stitching the turned under edges to the body of the insignia using 1/16 to 1/8 inch stitching margin with 12 to 16 stitches per inch, in accordance with Stitching Type 301 (Figure 11) and Stitching Type Efa-1 (Figure 250) of ASTM D6193. The corners and points of the cloth shall be neatly turned and caught in the stitching so that no raw edge is exposed on the front of the finished insignia. The turning, when completed, shall produce a border on the face side of size 1 insignia of 3/16 + 0, - 1/16 inch and on size 2 insignia of 1/8 + 1/16, - 0 inch from finished edge of embroidery and a point located at the apex of the insignia no wider than 1/8 + 1/16 inch - 0 inch. The two lower points of the PFC (class 11) insignia shall finish no wider than 1/8 + 1/16 inch - 0 inch.

3.5.3.4 Type III, Styles 3 and 4 on wool base cloth and Type VI, Style 2 on wool base cloth. These insignia shall be cleanly cut to form uniform edges and well defined corners and points. Sergeant Major of the Marine Corps grade insignia and service stripes shall be cut in pairs, one left and one right. In addition, the service stripe shall be cut with the top and bottom edges parallel with the warp and the bottom leading point of the sides cut on a 30 º angle to the warp. The insignia shall also be cut to provide a 3/16 inch border.

3.5.3.5 Type VI, Style 1 and Type VII. These insignia shall be cut in strips, one unit wide and approximately one yard in length. A yard may contain no more than two pieces and shall be attached with tape at the cut on the reverse side. The side of the strips shall be cut so as to have a 1/8 inch border outside the embroidered edge.

3.5.3.6 Type I, Style 4, Type IV, and Type V. These insignia shall be cut so that a minimum of 5/8 inch base material is available between the design and raw edge.

3.6 Tolerances. Unless otherwise specified, the overall measurements of the finished insignia shall be within a tolerance of ± 1/8 inch of the required measurements. Where no tolerances are cited, design dimensions shall have a tolerance of ± 1/32 inch. Examination shall be in accordance with 4.3.3.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article (see 3.1) shall be made of a completely finished item or items for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

b. Conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth herein, except where otherwise indicated (see 6.2). Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z1.4.

4.2 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise stated, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.3.

4.3 Methods of inspection.

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4.3.1 Testing of components. Except as otherwise stated in TABLE III, testing of components shall be in accordance with the stated test method from FED-STD-191.

TABLE III. **Testing of components.**

COMPONENT	CHARACTERISTIC	RQM'T¶	TEST METHOD	RESULTS REPORTED AS
Embroidery yarn	material identification	3.3.1.1	ASTM-D276; **1**/	pass or fail
	ply	3.3.1.1	visual	pass or fail
	denier	3.3.1.1	ASTM-D1907	to nearest denier
	presence of sulfur	3.3.1.2	**2**/	pass or fail
	color matching	3.3.1.3	visual	pass or fail
	colorfastness	3.3.1.4	5622	pass or fail
Bobbin yarn	material identification	3.3.2	ASTM-D276; **1**/	pass or fail
	ply	3.3.2	visual	pass or fail
	color	3.3.2	visual	pass or fail
	presence of sulfur	3.3.2	**2**/	pass or fail
	colorfastness	3.3.2	5622	pass or fail
Stitching thread	material identification	3.3.3	ASTM-D276; **1**/	pass or fail
	ply	3.3.3	visual	pass or fail
	color	3.3.3	visual	pass or fail
	presence of sulfur	3.3.3	**2**/	pass or fail
	colorfastness	3.3.3	5622	pass or fail
Overedge stitching yarn/thread	material identification	3.3.4.1	ASTM-D276; **1**/	pass or fail
	ply	3.3.4.1	visual	pass or fail
	denier	3.3.4.1	ASTM-D1907	to nearest denier
	color	3.3.4.2	visual	pass or fail
	presence of sulfur	3.3.4.2	**2**/	pass or fail
	colorfastness	3.3.4.3	5622	pass or fail
Base cloth	material identification	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	ASTM-D276; **1**/	pass or fail
	weave	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	visual	pass or fail
	weight	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	ASTM-D3776, Option A	nearest 0.1 oz/ sq yd
	weave	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	visual	pass or fail
	breaking strength: warp & filling	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	ASTM-D5034, Tests G-E	nearest 1 lb.
	shrinkage: warp & filling	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	AATCC-96-Test Vc, D & AATCC-99 respectively	nearest 0.1%
	colorfastness	3.3.5.1 & 3.3.5.2	5622	pass or fail
	color	3.3.5.3	visual	pass or fail
Backing material	weave	3.3.6	visual	pass or fail
	weight	3.3.6	ASTM-D3776, Option A	nearest 0.1 oz/ sq yd

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TABLE III. **Testing of components. -** Continued.

COMPONENT	CHARACTERISTIC	RQM'T¶	TEST METHOD	RESULTS REPORTED AS
	thread count: warp & filling	3.3.6	ASTM-D3775	pass or fail
	breaking strength: warp & filling	3.3.6	ASTM-D5034, Test G-E	nearest 1 lb.

1/ When specified in the contract or order, a contractor's certification of compliance may be accepted as evidence of conformance.
2/ Accepted on contractor's certification of compliance.

4.3.2 Visual examination of the end item. Visual examination of the completely finished item shall be made using the guidelines given in Table IV. The term "finished item" is defined as one insignia for each individual insignia, one pair for paired insignia, and one strip for insignia furnished in strips. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16-22 inches with illumination equal to average daylight and arranged so as to avoid as much reflected light as possible. Defects designated by an asterisk (✳) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

TABLE IV. **Visual examination of the end item.**

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION		
		MAJOR	(✳)	MINOR
Base cloth	Other than specified.	X		
	Any splice, cut, hole or tear visible on face.	X		
	Color/shade not as specified.	X		
Stiffener/Backing	Backing material omitted or incomplete when required.	X		
	Back not coated with rubber base adhesive when required.	X		
	Coating not uniform; incomplete.			X
	Backing material protrudes more than 1/32 inch beyond finished insignia.			X
	Stiffener visible on front.	X		
	Stiffener/backing not as specified.	X		
Embroidery, General	Embroidery yarn not an acceptable match.	X		
	Background not as specified.	X		
	Device not as specified.	X		
	Background not interlocked in evenly spaced rows	X		
	Spacing of rows not in accordance with cartoon. .		✳	
	Non-uniform embroidery stitch density.		✳	
	Bobbin thread showing on face.		✳	
	Tight tension; distorted surface of face side.	X		
	Loose tension; loopy surface.	X		
	Traveling (walking) stitches on face of insignia. . .		✳	
	Broken stitches or stitching incomplete (missing). .		✳	

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TABLE IV. **Visual examination of the end item.** - Continued.

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION		
		MAJOR	(*)	MINOR
Design	Any departure from cartoon or drawing.	X		
	Design or device poorly defined, sharp outline lacking.	X		
	Shift; device or outline misshapen.		*	
	Device flat; underlay missing or not well rounded or prominent; underlay insufficient.	X		
	Design inadequately covers base cloth; background or underlay showing through (thin or uneven stitch density).	X		
	Border not constructed of schrage stitches or a combination of blatt and stiele stitches when required.	X		
	Stiele stitches not firmly drawn to produce clearly defined rows or edges.	X		
	Stiele stitch in arcs, bars, or device not as required by cartoon.	X		
Workmanship, General	Kinked, bunched, tangled yarn on face.		*	
	Broken, scuffed, or cut yarns on face.	X		
	Spot, stain, stiffener, or foreign matter on face. . . .		*	
	Two or more thread ends untrimmed.			X
	Creased or folded; will not flatten by manual pressure.		*	
	Not paired, left and right, when required.	X		
	Embroidery yarn not an acceptable match when paired.	X		
Finishing	Types I; III on wool base cloth; VI, Style 2; & VIII - Borders & Overedge			
	Omitted completely or not as specified.	X		
	Final free end not secured on back of insignia as specified.		*	
	Final free end not specified length.			X
	Overedge does not adequately cover border.	X		
	Bunched or tangled yarns.		*	
	Broken or skipped stitches.		*	
	Raveled; ends not secured.		*	
	Run-off; not caught in base cloth.		*	
	Not 20-28 stitches per inch on overedge.		*	
	Start and finish not at specified point.		*	
	Angles or pointed corners rounded off.	X		
	Too tight or too loose tension.			X
	Overedge less than 3/32 or more than 5/32 inch in length.		*	
	Adhesive from final end exposed on finished edge		*	

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TABLE IV. **Visual examination of the end item.** - Continued.

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION		
		MAJOR	(*)	MINOR
	Cut shrage or border stitches not adequately covered by overedge stitching.	X		
	Wrong stitch type.	X		
	Type III; VI, Style 2; IX; X; XI; XII (as applicable) - Hems & Edges			
	Any raw edge not turned under.	X		
	Any raw edge not firmly attached to back of insignia by stitching.		*	
	Stitching irregular or unevenly gauged.		*	
	Hem stitching less than 12 or more than 16 inches per inch.		*	
	Loose tension, loopy thread on hem.		*	
	Wrong seam type or stitching type.	X		
	Corners and points not mitered, creased, and folded down neatly (open or poorly formed).		*	
	Corners and points not caught on back by stitching.		*	
	Stitching margin not as specified.		*	
	Opposing corners not uniform in appearance.	X		
	Upper or lower apex point more than 3/16 inch. . .	X		
	Bottom leading point of sides not cut 30° angle to warp.		*	
	Top and bottom edges not parallel to warp when required.			X
	Types IV, V, VI, and VII (as applicable) - Base Cloth Borders			
	Not uniform in width or unevenly trimmed.		*	
	Not cut in strips one unit wide when required.	X		
	Corners or points not well defined.		*	
	Free material between edge of design and raw edge of material not as specified.	X		
	Not cut in single units when required.	X		

4.3.3 Examination for dimensions. Measurements shall be taken of all points, lines, areas, curves, radii, and spaces for which dimensions are specified in the drawing, including:

Overall length
Overall width
Border width
Turn-under
Device location
Device dimension
Spaces and distances between intermediate points

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Width of stiele stitch in Marine Corps insignia
Width of background for Marine Corps insignia

Tolerances shall be as specified in 3.6. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a major defect.

4.3.4 End item testing. Except as otherwise stated in TABLE V, testing of the completely finished item(s) shall be in accordance with FED-STD-191. The term "finished item" is defined as one insignia for each individual insignia, one pair for paired insignia, and one strip for insignia furnished in strips.

TABLE V. **End item testing.**

CHARACTERISTIC	RQM'T ¶	TEST METHOD
Colorfastness of embroidery & overedge stitching yarn:		
Wet-dry cleaning	3.3.1.4 & 3.3.4.3	5622
Light	3.3.1.4 & 3.3.4.3	AATCC-16, Option A
Laundering **1**/	3.3.1.4 & 3.3.4.3	AATCC-61, Test 3A
Overedge stitching:		
Stitches per inch	3.5.3.1	5052 **2**/

1/ Only the stain on the fiber of the color transfer cloth represented in the basic materials being tested, shall be evaluated.

2/ The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature which may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The insignia covered by this specification are intended to be worn by Department of Defense personnel to designate wearers' grade/rank, length of service, or overseas service.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type, style, size, and class required (see 1.2).
c. Drawing/cartoon number (see 2.2.2).
d. Issue of DoDISS to be cited in the solicitation and, if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.2.1).
e. When a first article is required (see 3.1).
f. Packaging requirements (see 5.1 and 6.6).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When first article inspection is required (see 3.1), the contracting office should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item(s) should be a preproduction sample, a first production sample, or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.5 Government furnished property. The contracting office should arrange to furnish the cartoons and drawings required in 6.2.

6.6 Suggested unit packaging. Packaging, packing, preservation, marking, and any acceptance criteria will be in accordance with 5.1. Suggested unit packaging is given below. Please note that acceptable unit packaging may take a number of different forms commercial wrapping paper; clear blister or "bubble" wrap; shrink wrap; bags made of commercial grade paper, clear plastic, or clear blister/"bubble" pack closed by tying, taping, or heat-sealing, as appropriate. The intention is to keep a stated number of units of issue together for counting, marking, and intermediate packaging (if any) and to do so in a manner that does no damage to the insignia during handling, shipping, and storing.

6.6.1 Type I, Styles1, 2, and 3; Type IX; Type X; Type XI; and Type XII. Insignia of one type, style, size (where applicable), and class may be put up in bundles of twenty each.

6.6.2 Type I, Styles 4 and 5; Type IV; and Type V. Insignia of one type, style, class, and size (where applicable) may be organized in pairs and put up in groups of ten pairs. A pair of Type V, Class I insignia of any style consists of one left-hand and one right-hand insignia.

6.6.3 Type III, Styles 1 and 3, Classes 2 through 11 and Type III, Styles 2 and 4. Insignia of one type, style, size, and class may be put up in bundles of ten pairs.

6.6.4 Type III, Styles 1 and 3, Class 1 and Type VI, Style 2. Pairs of these insignia consist of one left-hand and one right-hand insignia. Matched pairs may be put up in groups of ten consisting of the same type, style, size, class, and subclass (where applicable).

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6.6.5 Type VI, Style 1 and Type VII. The unit for packaging has customarily been insignia in strips of approximately one yard in length, each folded neatly in half, with each strip containing the minimum number of insignia as shown herein. A strip may be pieced together to obtain the minimum number. A strip should be comprised of no more than two pieces attached with tape at the cut on the reverse side. Twenty folded strips, placed ten high and two wide comprise a packaging unit.

Type, Style, Size	Minimum Number of Insignia
Type VI, Style 1, Size 1	60
Type VI, Style 1, Size 2	85
Type VII, Size 1	85
Type VII, Size 2	100

6.6.6 Type VIII. Insignia of one style, size, and class may be put up in bundles of six pairs.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Backing, rubber base adhesive
Bobbin yarn
Buckram
Cartoon
Colorfastness
Denier
Multihead
Schiffli
Stiffener
Stitch, background
Stitch, blatt
Stitch, blind
Stitch, border
Stitch, overedge
Stitch, schrage
Stitch, stiele
Stitch, underlay
Sulfur

6.8 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11
Navy - NU

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Air Force - 84, 99
Navy - MC
DLA - CT

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INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
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3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER MIL-DTL-14651A	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYYYMMDD) 20011022

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
INSIGNIA, EMBROIDERED, RANK, GRADE, AND SERVICE STRIPES, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME *(Last, First, Middle Initial)*	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)*	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON *(if applicable)*	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYYYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

NAME The Institute of Heraldry, Dept. of the Army	b. TELEPHONE *Include Area Code)* (1) Commercial 703-806-4982 (2) AUTOVON 656-4982
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)* 9325 Gunston Rd., Bldg. 1466, Rm S-112 Fort Belvoir, Virginia 22060-5579	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Standardization Program Office (DLSC-LM) 8725 John J. Kingman road, Suite 2533, Ft. Belvoir, VA 22060-2533 Telephone (703) 767-6888 AUTOVON 427-6888

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